- HTTPS is used to encrypt your app's data as it travels from the server to the browser and back. This encryption prevents third parties from seeing or modifying it.
- HTTPS is virtually mandatory for production apps, as modern browsers like Chrome and Firefox mark non-HTTPS apps as explicitly "not secure."
- In production, you can avoid handling the TLS in your app by using SSL/TLS offloading. This is where a reverse proxy uses HTTPS to talk to the browser, but the traffic is unencrypted between your app and the reverse proxy. The reverse proxy could be on the same or a different server, such as IIS or NGINX, or it could be a third-party service, such as Cloudflare.
- You can use the ASP.NET Core developer certificate or the IIS express developer certificate to enable HTTPS during development. This can't be used for production, but it's sufficient for testing locally. You must run `dotnet dev-certs https --trust` when you first install the .NET SDK to trust the certificate.
- Kestrel is the default web server in ASP.NET Core. It is responsible for reading and writing data from and to the network, parsing the bytes based on the underlying HTTP and network protocols and converting from raw bytes to .NET objects you can use in your apps.